



AS THE SPORT CONTINUES TO PROFESSIONALISE, FAZEL ASPIRES TO ELEVATE IT TO A GLOBAL STAGE, INCLUDING THE OLYMPICS



and an even better person. He always treats us all equally. There is only one player in the world who has played four Asian Games,” says Paltan skipper Aslam Inamdar, who played under Fazel in season nine.

Not only is he supportive of his teammates, but he also shares his experience with opposition players. He believes it’s his responsibility to guide younger players.

“In PKL, we’re constantly moving between teams. As a seasoned player, it’s my duty to mentor the youngsters. It brings me joy to see them grow,” he says.

Youngsters Nitin Kumar and Sushil Kambrekar have been impressive for Warriorz this season. Fazel expressed his pleasure, saying, “I’m glad they’re getting recognition. Bengal’s young players are eager to learn and improve, and I’m learning from them too.”

An ardent judo enthusiast, the defender possesses a warrior’s spirit, defying critics who question his age and influence. “Every season, they think my time is done. Now, I’m 32 years old, I have 500 tackle points, and I’m still giving my best on the mat. That makes me really happy,” Fazel says.

As his career winds down towards its last phase, the legendary defender is focused on his legacy. Beyond medals and stats, he values respect from his peers.

“I want to be remembered as a good person, not just a good player. Medals and stats are fleeting, but respect is lasting. I don’t want to be known for a bad attitude. The sport is bigger than any one person,” he concludes.

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